

Michele — Three-Month Plan

From B2 to C1 by August 2026 · 24 lessons · 12 weeks · 2 lessons per week

What this document is. A complete 24-lesson roadmap built from your trial assessment. Every lesson below already exists — you can click any link to preview. We move in three phases: fix the high-yield grammar patterns first, then build listening and productive vocabulary, then push into C1 territory with sport-themed material aligned to your future career direction. You're a confident B2 with B2+ vocabulary — the work is in the small fixes that will sharpen everything.

The three phases

PHASE	WEEKS	FOCUS
1 — Fix & Build	Weeks 1–4 (May)	Italian-L1 grammar fixes (-ed/-ing, articles, used to, reported speech), B2 mistake-finding games, sport-themed conversation as the speaking vehicle. Confidence consolidation.
2 — Sharpen	Weeks 5–8 (June)	Listening with varied accents. Word stress and connected speech. Productive vocabulary push (B2 receptive → B2 active). Discourse markers and register shift.
3 — Push to C1	Weeks 9–12 (July–August)	Hedging at C1 level. Cleft sentences for emphasis. Strategic professional English. Sport-management English drawing on your Olympics work. C1 confirmation and exam decision.

How to use this document

Each lesson below has a short purpose line and a clickable link. Treat the schedule as flexible — if a topic clicks, slow down; if it lands fast, jump ahead. Aim to do the homework reading or game before each lesson where one is recommended. Bring your 10K race progress, ski mountaineering memories, and Olympics stories — the more you anchor language to your real life, the faster it sticks.

Phase 1 — Fix & Build

Weeks 1–4 (May 2026). Fix the high-yield Italian-L1 patterns that surfaced in the trial. Build speaking confidence with sport-themed B2 conversation. By the end of Phase 1 you should no longer say "the film was bored" — you should say "the film was boring" without thinking.

Week 1 — Foundations · Restart the engine after the trial

Lesson 1 · Adjectives & adverbs (intermediate)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/grammar_b1_13_adjectives_adverbs_intermediate.html

The headline lesson. -ed vs -ing adjectives. Rule: -ed describes how YOU feel; -ing describes the QUALITY of the thing. "The film was very boring" — not "bored". You hit this exact pattern in the trial.

Lesson 2 · Articles & zero article

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/grammar_b1_11_articles_zero_article.html

The other Italian-L1 elephant. When to drop "the" with general topics: "football" not "the football"; "language" not "the language". Direct fix for what we heard in the trial.

Week 2 — Past, present, habit · Tense discrimination

Lesson 3 · "Used to" / "would" for past habits

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/lesson_04_used_to_would.html

The classic pair you were unclear on in the trial. "I used to play" (past habit, finished) vs "I'm used to waking early" (current ongoing habit). Two completely different things — clear them up.

Lesson 4 · Past continuous in narrative

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/lesson_02_past_continuous.html

Sets up the storytelling muscle. "I was riding when I fell" — interrupted past actions. Useful immediately for telling stories about your races, the Olympics, ski mountaineering.

Week 3 — Reporting & modals · Two recurring grammar holes

Lesson 5 · Reported speech — core

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/grammar_b1_08_reported_speech_core.html

The tense backshift you missed in the A2 mistake-finding game ("told me she didn't want"). High-frequency in real conversation — when you tell anyone what someone else said.

Lesson 6 · Modals of obligation & request

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/grammar_a2_04_modals_obligation_request.html

Quick reset on must / have to / should / can / could. Foundation refresher before we move into C1 modal nuances later.

Week 4 — Consolidate with sport · Speaking the language of your interest

Lesson 7 · Taking up a sport (B2 conversation)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/b2_28_taking_up_a_sport.html

Sport-themed speaking practice. Anchor: your 10K race in Brisbane next month. Apply the grammar from Weeks 1–3 in a topic you actually care about.

Lesson 8 · Hot Takes — Sport (B2)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/gr_warmup_b2_hot_takes_sport.html

Argumentative speaking on sport topics. Push back on opinions, defend a position. Naturally surfaces the discourse markers we'll formalize in Phase 2.

End of Phase 1 check. By Week 4 you should be auto-correcting -ed/-ing without thinking, naturally dropping "the" with general topics, and using "used to" and "be used to" without confusion. If anything still feels shaky, we'll spend an extra session before moving on.

Phase 2 — Sharpen

Weeks 5–8 (June 2026). Listening with varied accents (the Australian-pace problem you flagged). Word stress and connected speech. Move B2 vocabulary from "I recognize it" to "I use it." Discourse markers and register shift.

Week 5 — Listening foundations · Train the ear

Lesson 9 · Active listening (A2 starter — quick)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/sp_a2_06_active_listening.html

Quick foundation lesson. Strategies for catching what you'd otherwise miss: predict, chunk, confirm. We'll scale up immediately into B1/B2 material.

Lesson 10 · Everyone has an accent (B1/B2)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/everyone_has_an_accent_b1b2.html

Direct attack on your trial-flagged problem: fast colleague-to-colleague speech vs slowed-down speech-to-you. Builds the mental flexibility for accent variation.

Week 6 — Pitch, stress, rhythm · How English actually sounds

Lesson 11 · Pitch drop interactive (B2 listening)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/general_listening_b2_pitch_drop_interactive.html

Interactive listening drill. Hearing where the stress falls — the engine of natural English rhythm. Builds the muscle for understanding rapid speech.

Lesson 12 · Stress shift (B2)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/gr_b2_stress_shift.html

VERSatile or verSATile? PERceptive or perCEPTive? You stressed several B2 words wrong in the trial. This lesson drills the patterns that govern stress-shift in English.

Week 7 — Productive vocabulary · Move recognition into use

Lesson 13 · Articles in depth (B2)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/grammar_b2_12_articles_in_depth.html

Phase 1 covered the basics. This is the upgrade — definite, indefinite, zero article in nuanced contexts. The patterns C1 examiners will check.

Lesson 14 · Cleft sentences for emphasis (B2)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/grammar_b2_11_cleft_sentences_emphasis.html

"It was the salary that drew me in" / "What surprised me most was...". A C1 marker — these structures lift writing and speaking instantly. Useful for your future sport-management work.

Week 8 — Discourse & register · Sound the part

Lesson 15 · Discourse markers — connect (Bestiary)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/bestiary_discourse_connect.html

How fluent speakers stitch ideas together: however, in fact, that being said, on the contrary. Stops your speech from feeling list-like.

Lesson 16 · Register shift (B2)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/sp_b2_49_register.html

Formal vs informal. Same idea, different audience. Critical for sport-management — you'll need to write differently to a sponsor, a journalist, a teammate.

End of Phase 2 check. By Week 8, fast Australian speech should feel less overwhelming. You should be using cleft sentences, varying your discourse markers, and shifting register on demand. Phase 3 takes you firmly into C1 territory with material that mirrors your career direction.

Phase 3 — Push to C1

Weeks 9–12 (July–August 2026). C1 territory: hedging at expert level, professional English, sport-management content drawing on your Olympics work. Final consolidation before September.

Week 9 — Hedging at C1 · Sound thoughtful, not aggressive

Lesson 17 · Strong hedging (B2 → C1)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/sp_b2_42_strong_hedging.html

The five power-phrases that lift hedged speech to C1: in all likelihood, it stands to reason, one would assume, reasonable to suppose, strong case to be made. Strategic and professional.

Lesson 18 · Active listening (C1 professional)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/c1_pro_04_active_listening.html

Active listening at C1 level — the kind of attentive comprehension you'll need in sport-management meetings, journalist interactions, and senior-level conversations.

Week 10 — Strategic communication · The professional layer

Lesson 19 · Strategic emails (C1 professional)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/c1_pro_01_strategic_emails.html

Writing emails that get results. Subject lines, openers, asks, sign-offs. The exact register sport-management roles require — sponsors, federations, athletes, agents.

Lesson 20 · Sporting events (B2 → C1)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/b2_20_sporting_events.html

Specific sport-event vocabulary and discussion language. Anchor: your Olympics experience. The language you'd need in a sport-management interview.

Week 11 — Sport application · Where it all comes together

Lesson 21 · Alternative sports (B2)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/b2_14_alternative_sports.html

Discussion of less-mainstream sports — your ski mountaineering territory. Natural setting for the cleft sentences, hedging, and register work from earlier weeks.

Lesson 22 · Great achievements (B2 → C1)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/b2_08_great_achievements.html

Discussing achievements at length — sport, personal, professional. Sets up the way you'll talk about your own background in interviews and applications.

Week 12 — Capstone · Confirm C1, plan ahead

Lesson 23 · Hot Takes — Money, Work (B2 hot debates)

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/gr_warmup_b2_hot_takes_money.html

Capstone speaking lessons. Argue both sides of money/work topics relevant to sport-management economics. The B2 mistake-game ([gr_b2_time_auction.html](#)) you got at trial can also slot in here for review.

Lesson 24 · Time auction — full review

https://malcolmhyndman.com/preply-lessons/gr_b2_time_auction.html

Full review session. The auction game from your trial — this time as a benchmark. If you sail through, we have evidence of C1 confirmation. Decision point: take CAE/IELTS for September, or move to advanced productive work.

After September

When you head back to Italy, you'll have a documented B2 → C1 progression and a body of sport-themed English work specific to your career direction. The natural next steps would be (1) formal certification (CAE / IELTS) if useful for sport-management applications, (2) targeted lessons on the business of sport — sponsorship, governance, event management, media — drawing on your real Olympics experience, or (3) interview practice for specific roles. We'll pick the path that matches what you've decided to do next.

One closing note. You came into the trial saying "the level is very low" and "I always have problem with the language." That assessment is wrong. You're a confident B2 with B2+ vocabulary, comfortable arguing both sides of a topic, and engaged enough to come to Australia alone. The work in the next 12 weeks is small, targeted fixes — not rebuilding from the ground up. By the end of August, the words "I always have problem" should sound strange to you.